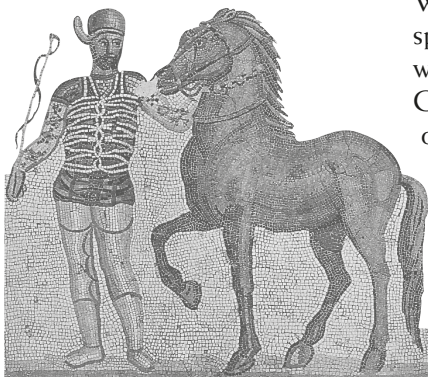




IN THIS MOSAIC OF AN ANIMAL SHOW, A MAN SENTENCED TO BE KILLED BY WILD ANIMALS IS WHEELED TO HIS DEATH. ANOTHER MAN IS ATTACKED TO HIS LEFT.

leopards, and tigers ripped them to shreds. It was a slow, painful death. These executions took place at lunchtime, and some Romans were sickened by the sight—it was enough to turn their stomachs!



A visit to the race track

Another favorite Roman spectator sport was chariot racing. Just as the Colosseum was the biggest arena in the Roman world, the Circus Maximus ("Greatest Circus"), also in Rome, was the largest of all circuses, or race tracks. Measuring 1,970 ft (600 m) long and 260 ft (80 m) wide, the track formed a long, narrow rectangle with rounded ends. With room for about 200,000 spectators, the Circus Maximus was four times larger than the Colosseum and bigger than any of today's super-stadiums!

Charioteers were thought of as low-class people, just as gladiators and animal fighters

A CHARIOTEER OF THE VENETI, OR BLUE TEAM, STANDS BY HIS HORSE.